Validate GitLab CI/CD configuration

Tier: Free, Premium, Ultimate

Offering: GitLab.com, GitLab Self-Managed, GitLab Dedicated

Use the CI Lint tool to check the validity of GitLab CI/CD configuration. You can validate the syntax from a `.gitlab-ci.yml` file or any other sample CI/CD configuration. This tool checks for syntax and logic errors, and can simulate pipeline creation to try to find more complicated configuration problems.

If you use the pipeline editor, it verifies configuration syntax automatically.

If you use VS Code, you can validate your CI/CD configuration with the GitLab for VS Code extension.

Check CI/CD syntax

The CI lint tool checks the syntax of GitLab CI/CD configuration, including configuration added with the `includes` keyword.

To check CI/CD configuration with the CI lint tool:

1. In the top bar, select **Search or go to** and find your project.
2. In the left sidebar, select **Build** > **Pipeline editor**.
3. Select the **Validate** tab.
4. Select **Lint CI/CD sample**.
5. Paste a copy of the CI/CD configuration you want to check into the text box.
6. Select **Validate**.

Simulate a pipeline

You can simulate the creation of a GitLab CI/CD pipeline to find more complicated issues, including problems with `needs` and `rules` configuration. A simulation runs as a Git `push` event on the default branch.

Prerequisites:

- You must have permissions to create pipelines on this branch to validate with a simulation.

To simulate a pipeline:

1. In the top bar, select **Search or go to** and find your project.
2. In the left sidebar, select **Build** > **Pipeline editor**.
3. Select the **Validate** tab.
4. Select **Lint CI/CD sample**.
5. Paste a copy of the CI/CD configuration you want to check into the text box.
6. Select **Simulate pipeline creation for the default branch**.
7. Select **Validate**.

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